FPFL User Guide

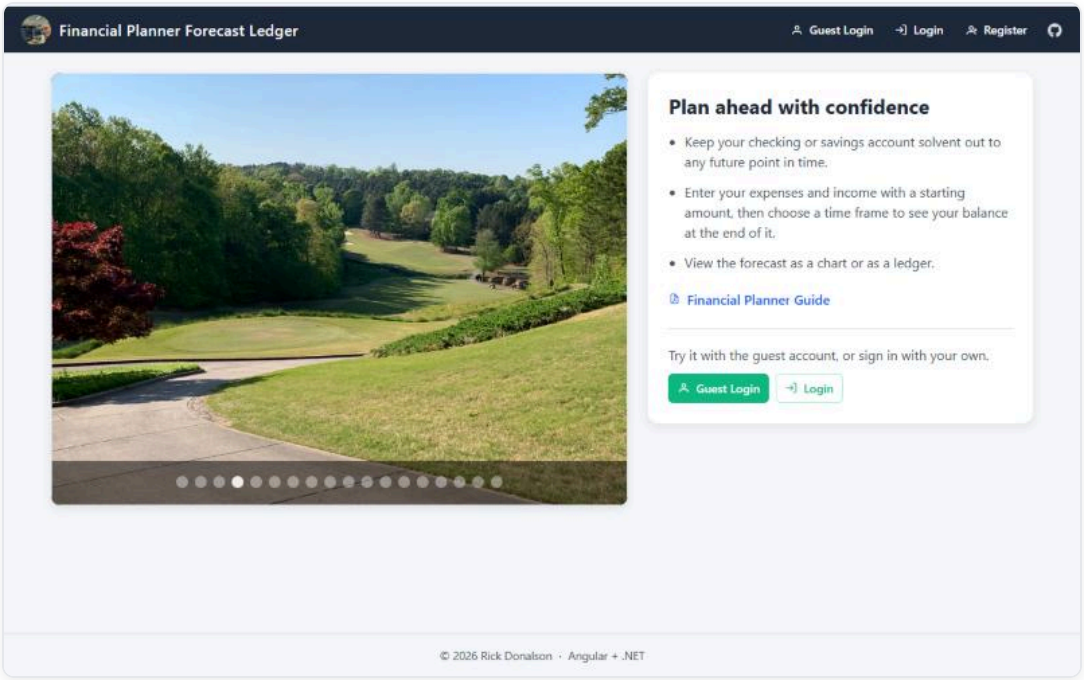
October 18, 2026 · Rick Donalson

FPFL (Financial Planner Forecast Ledger) forecasts your account balance day by day: enter a starting balance, your income (credits) and expenses (debits), pick a date range, and see where your balance will be — as a chart, a ledger, or an Excel workbook.

Getting started

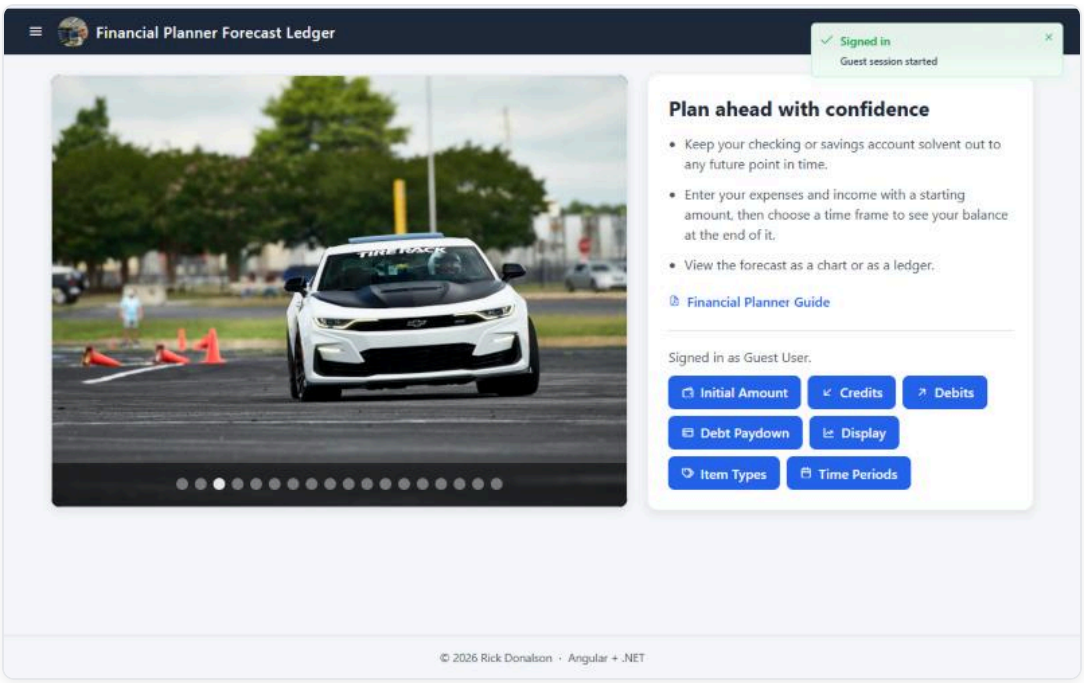
Open ui-ng.ledger-finance.com and sign in from the top bar or the home page.

- **Guest Login** signs you in to a shared demo account with sample credits, debits and a tracked debt. No password needed.
- **Login** signs in to your own account; **Register** creates one (name, email, password).
- Your session renews itself while you work. Two minutes before it would expire, a dialog offers **Stay logged in**.



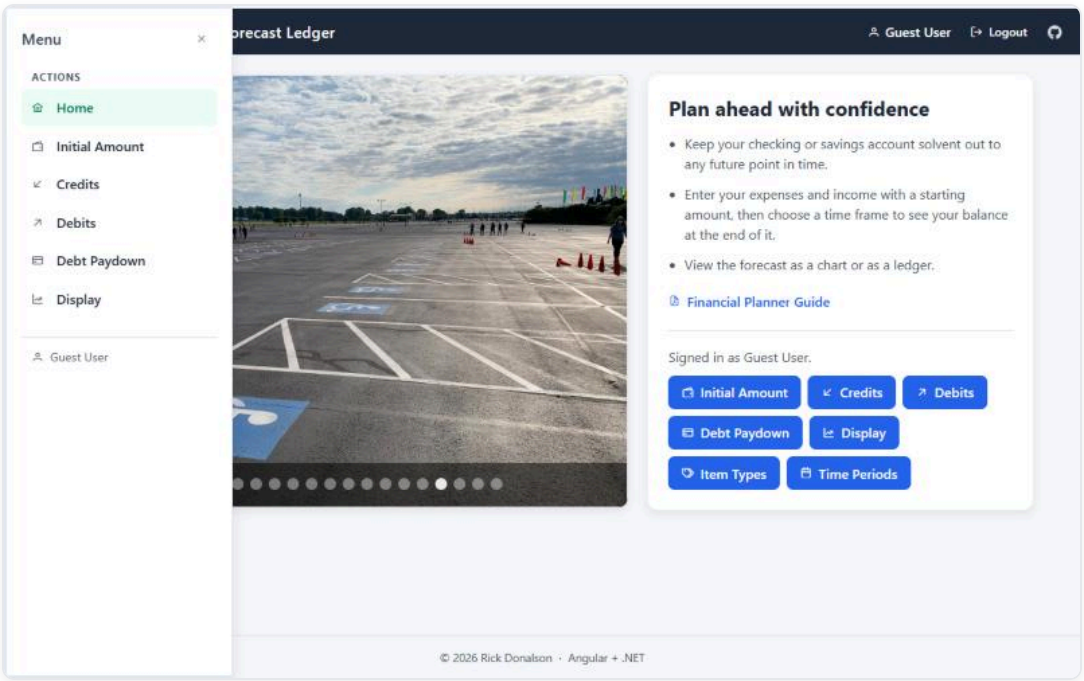
The home page before signing in

Once you're signed in, the home page shows a button for every part of the app, and the top bar shows your name, **Change Password** (not for the guest) and **Logout**.



The home page after signing in, with a button for each page

The ☰ button at the left of the top bar opens the menu. It lists the same pages and highlights the one you're on. Admins also see an **Admin** section with Item Types and Time Periods.



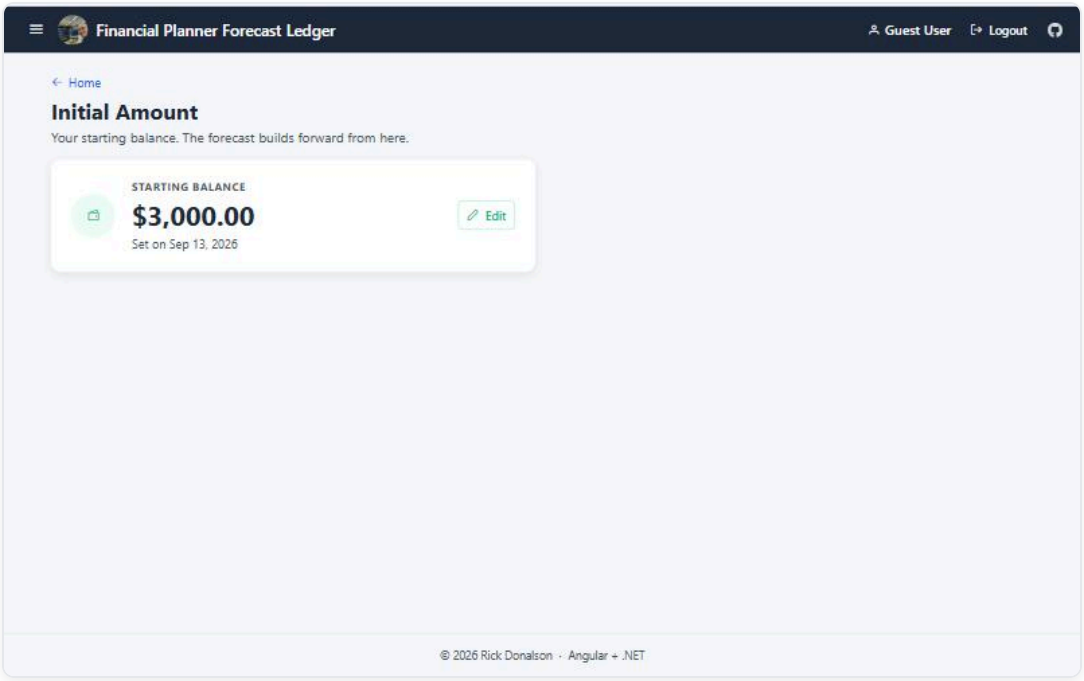
The side menu

A good order the first time: set your **Initial Amount**, add your **Credits** and **Debits**, then open **Display** to see the forecast.

Initial amount

Your initial amount is the balance the forecast starts from — usually what's in the account today. Every account gets one automatically at $0.00, so there's nothing to create.

1. Open **Initial Amount** from the menu or the home page.
2. Select **Edit**, type the new balance, and select **Save**.
3. The card shows the new amount and the date you set it.

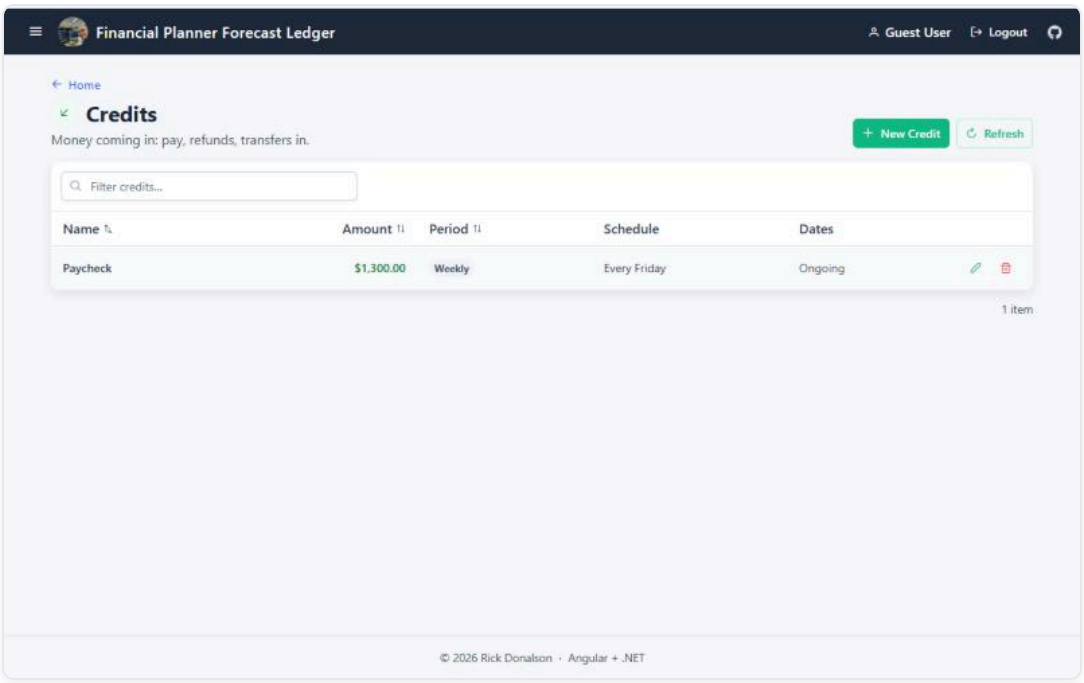


The Initial Amount page

Update it whenever you reconcile your account, so the forecast starts from a true number.

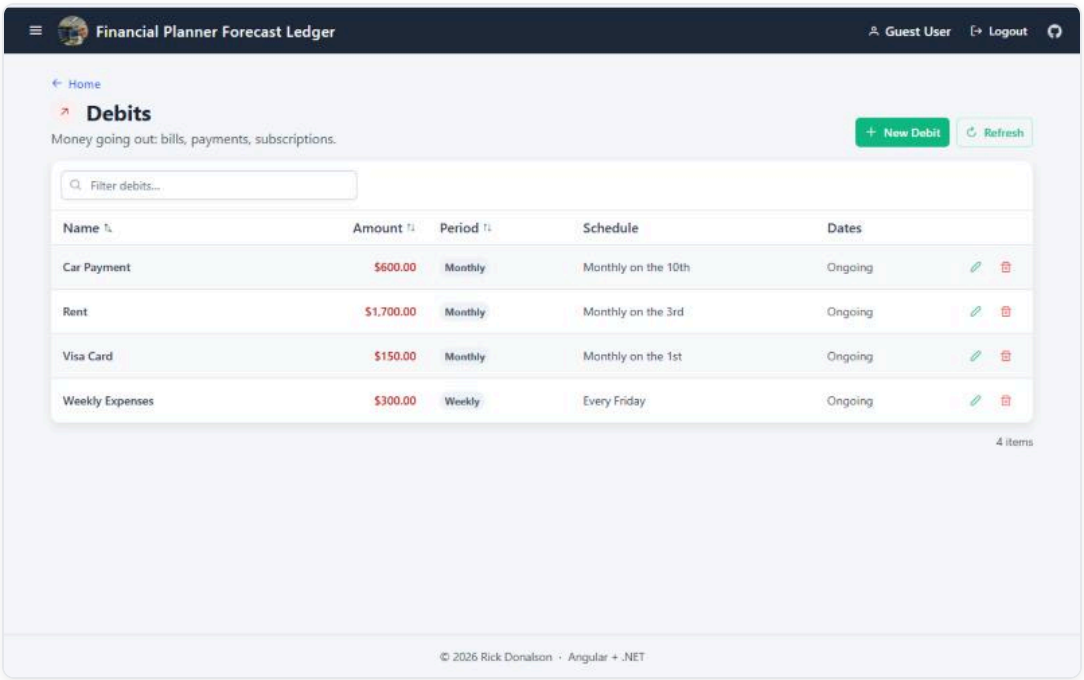
Credits and debits

Credits are money coming in (pay, refunds, transfers in); debits are money going out (bills, payments, subscriptions). Both pages work the same way.



The Credits list

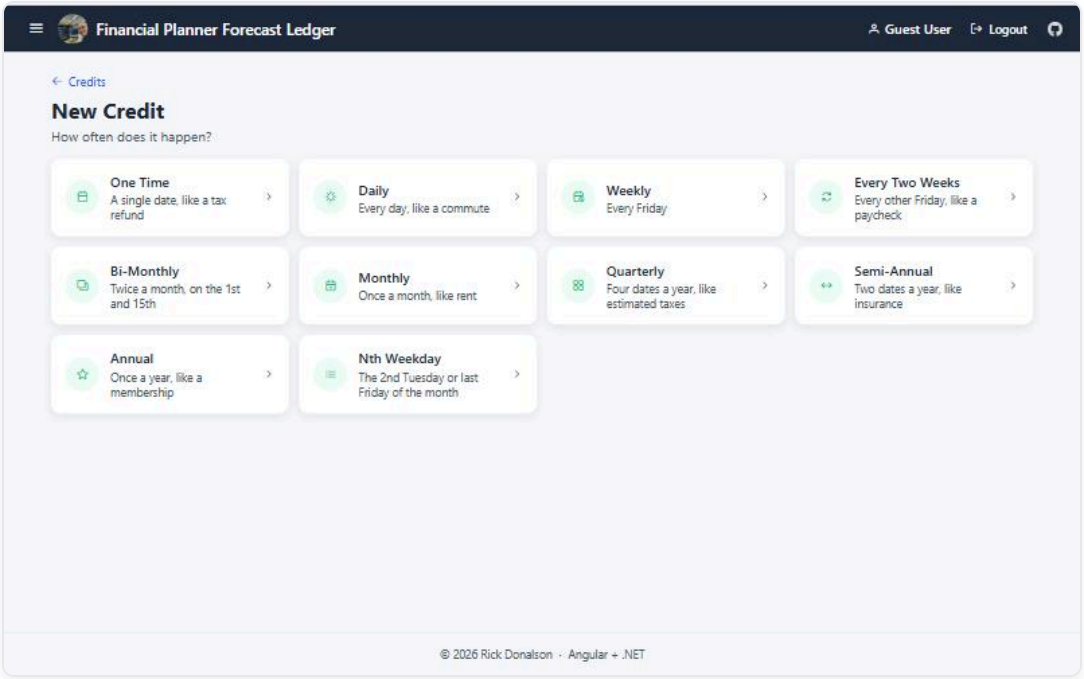
- Each row shows the name, amount, time period, a plain-English schedule ("Every Friday", "Monthly on the 10th") and its dates.
- Type in **Filter** to narrow the list; select a column heading to sort.
- The **pencil** edits an item; the **trash can** deletes it after you confirm.



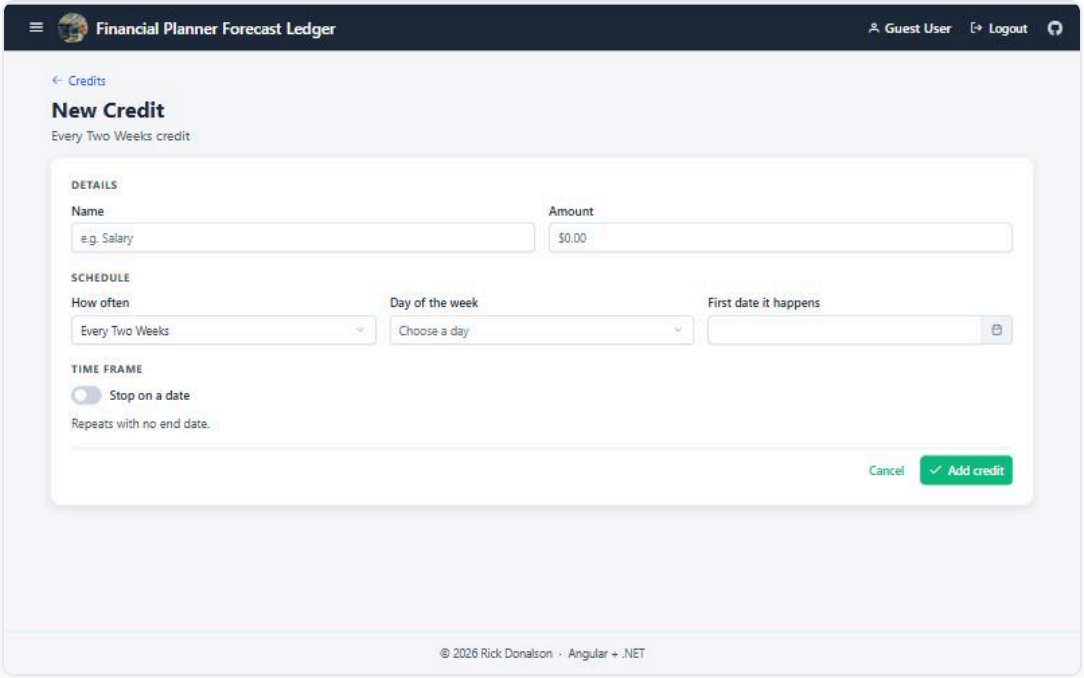
The Debits list

To add one:

1. Select **New Credit** (or **New Debit**).
2. Pick how often it happens. Each card gives an example.
3. Fill in the name, amount and the schedule fields for that period, then select **Add credit**.



Choosing how often a new credit happens



The form for an Every Two Weeks credit

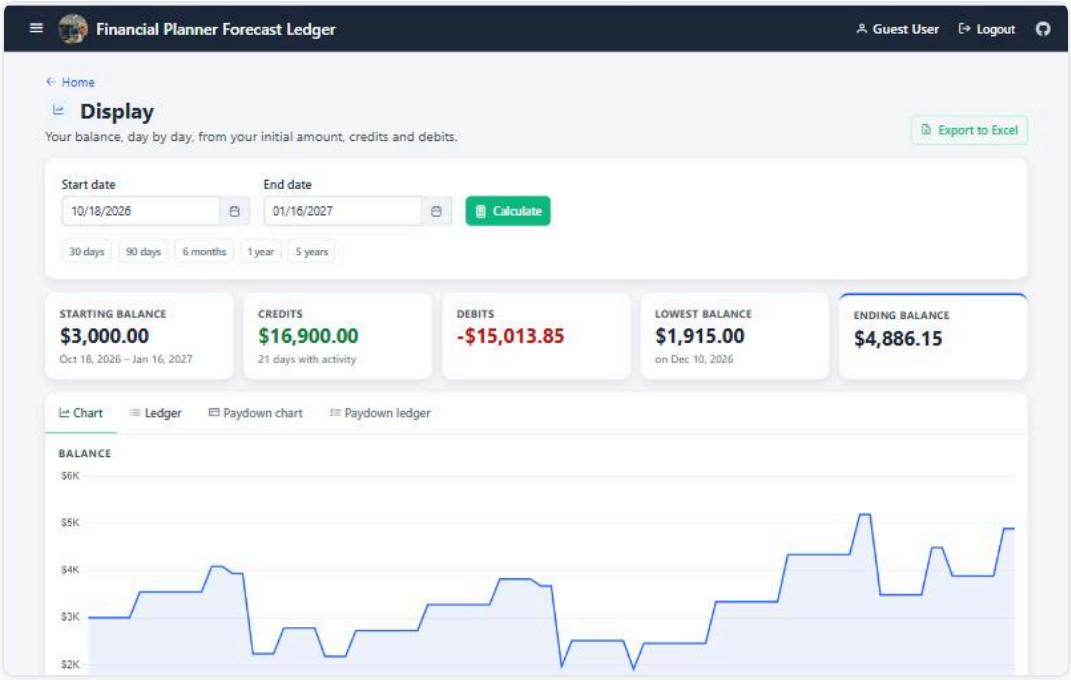
Time period	You choose	Example
One Time	A date	A tax refund
Daily	—	A commute
Weekly	A day of the week	Every Friday
Every Two Weeks	A day of the week and the first date	A paycheck every other Friday
Bi-Monthly	Two days of the month	The 1st and 15th
Monthly	A day of the month	Rent on the 3rd
Quarterly	Four month/day pairs	Estimated taxes
Semi-Annual	Two month/day pairs	Insurance
Annual	A month and day	A membership
Nth Weekday	Which week and weekday	The 2nd Tuesday or last Friday

A day past the end of a short month lands on its last day: "the 31st" is April 30, and Feb 29 is Feb 28 outside leap years. Turn on **Stop on a date** to give an item an end date.

Display: your forecast

Display shows your balance day by day. It opens with the next 90 days already calculated.

1. Change **Start date** and **End date**, or select a quick range (30 days to 5 years), then **Calculate**. A forecast can cover up to 10 years.
2. Read the summary tiles: starting balance, total credits and debits, your **lowest balance** and the day it happens, and the ending balance. A warning appears if the balance ever drops below $0.
3. Use the tabs below for the details.



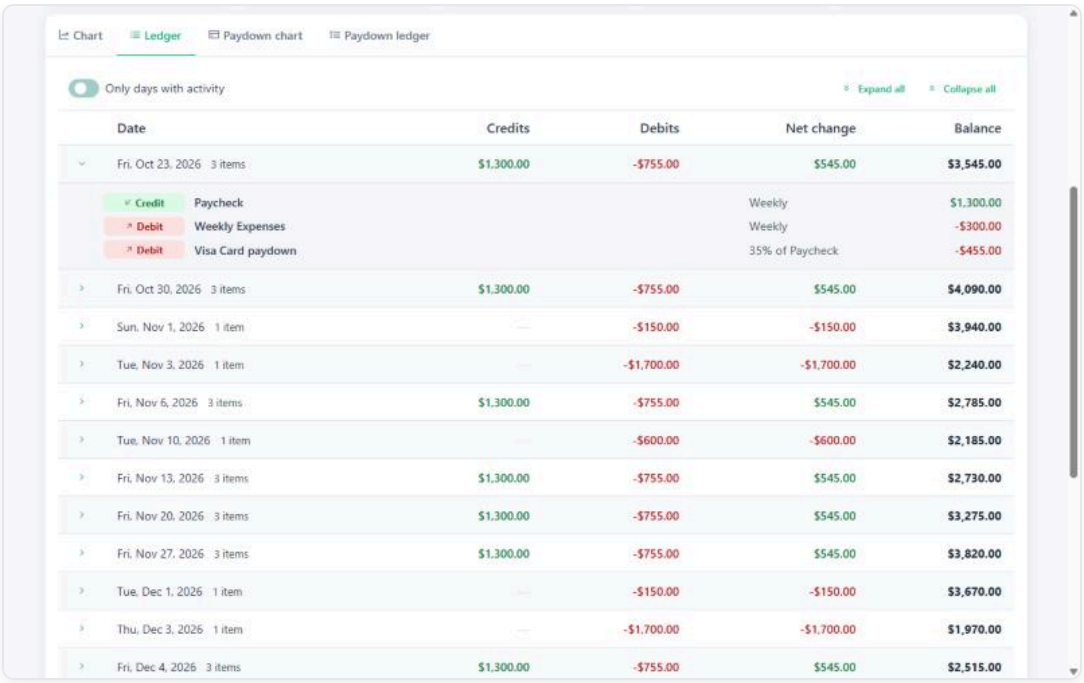
The Display page with its summary tiles

Chart — the top chart is your balance over time; the one below shows each day's credits (green, above zero) and debits (red, below). Hover for the exact amounts.



The Chart tab

Ledger — one row per day with credits, debits, net change and balance. Select the arrow on a day to see its items, or **Expand all**. **Only days with activity** hides the quiet days. Money sent to a tracked debt shows as a **Visa Card paydown** debit (see Debt Paydown).

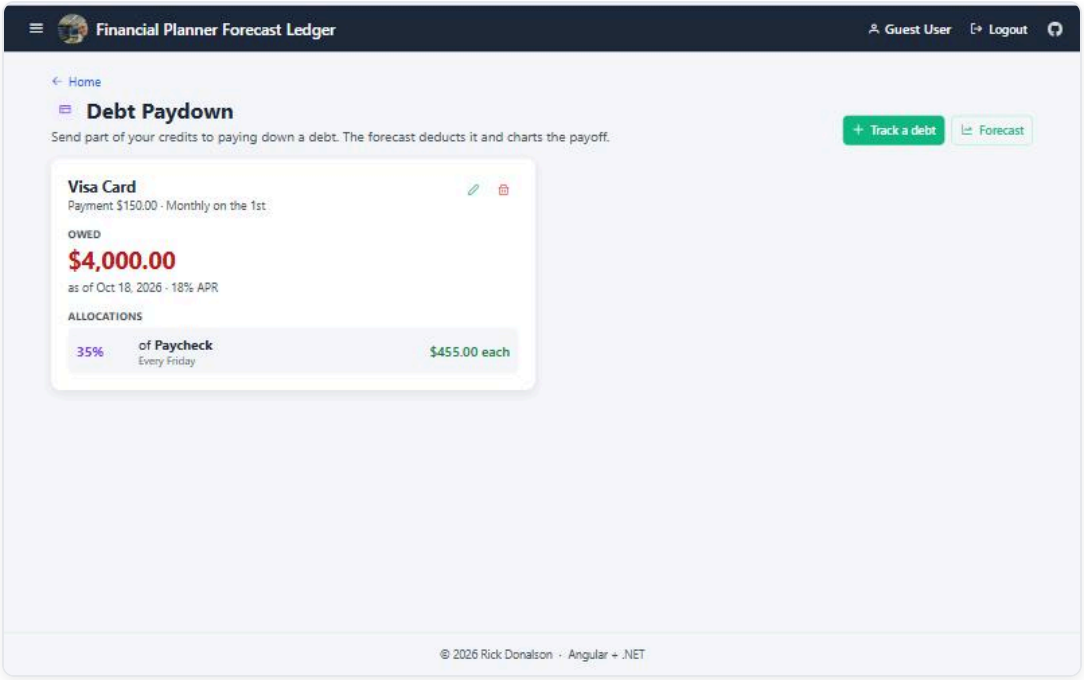


The Ledger tab with one day expanded

Export to Excel (top right) downloads the forecast as a workbook laid out like the ledger: each day's items sit in a collapsed group you open with Excel's **+** button, or open all at once with the **2** button at the top left. If you track debts, a second **Debt Paydown** sheet is included.

Debt Paydown

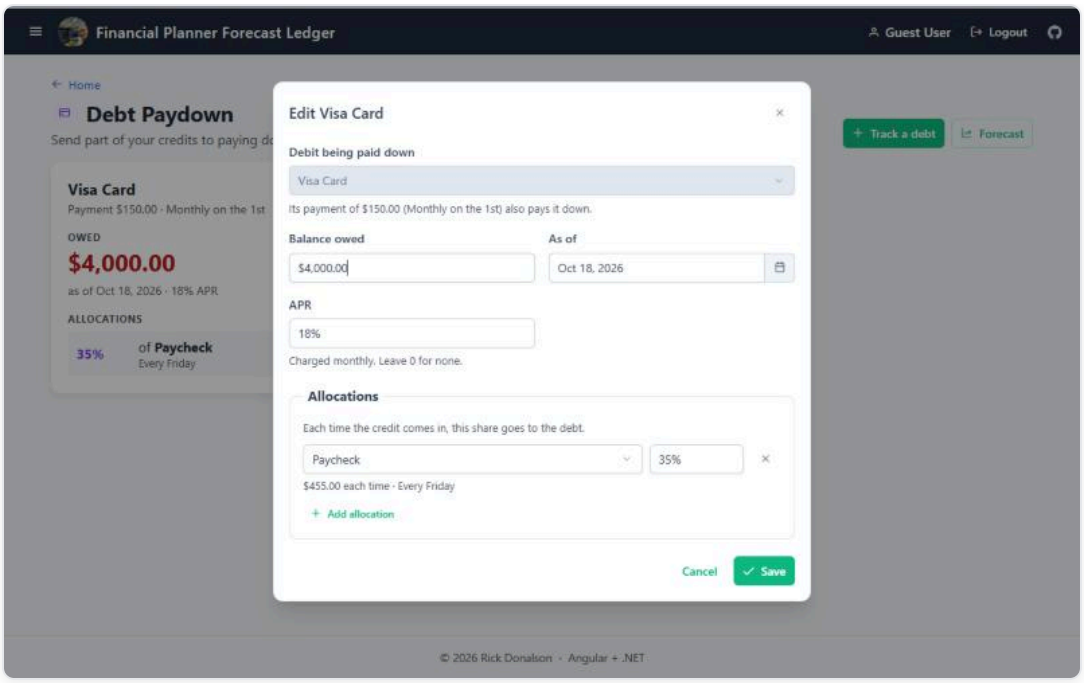
Debt Paydown shows how fast a debt such as a credit card gets paid off when you send part of your income to it. In the guest account, 35% of every $1,300 paycheck goes to a $4,000 Visa Card balance, which pays it off on Dec 18, 2026.



The Debt Paydown page

To track a debt:

1. Add the debt's regular payment as a **debit** first (for example "Visa Card, $150 monthly").
2. On **Debt Paydown**, select **Track a debt** and choose that debit. Its own payment also pays the debt down.
3. Enter the **balance owed**, the date it was true (**As of**), and the **APR** (0 for none; interest is charged monthly).
4. Select **Add allocation**, choose a credit and a percentage. The dialog shows the dollars sent each time ("$455.00 each time"). Add more credits the same way.
5. Select **Track debt** (or **Save** when editing).

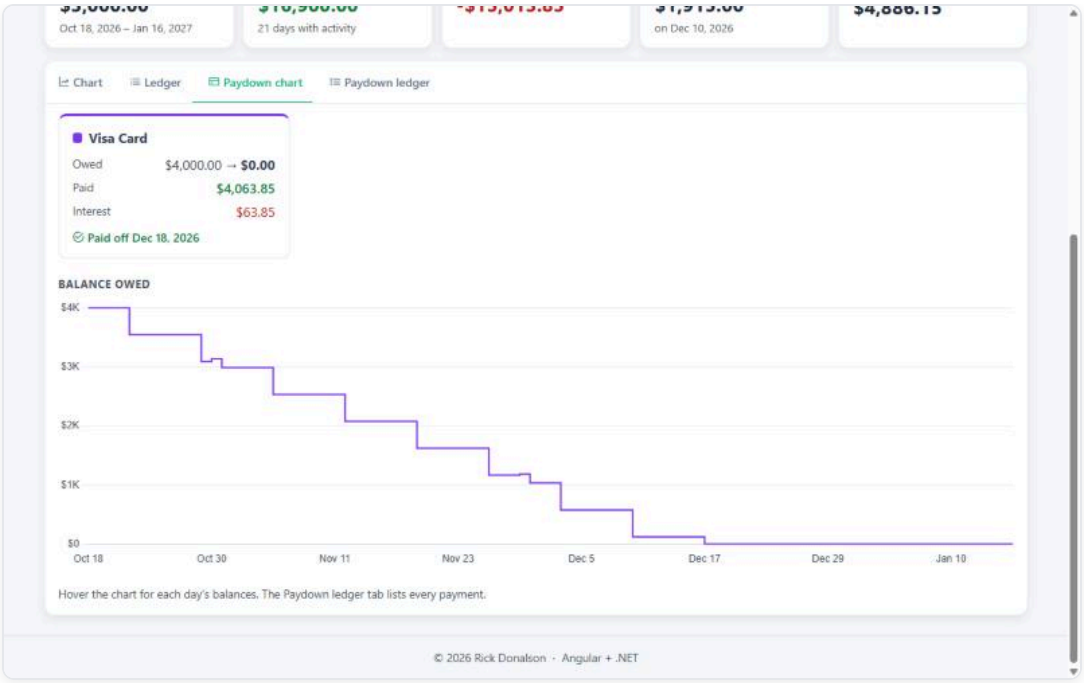


Editing a tracked debt

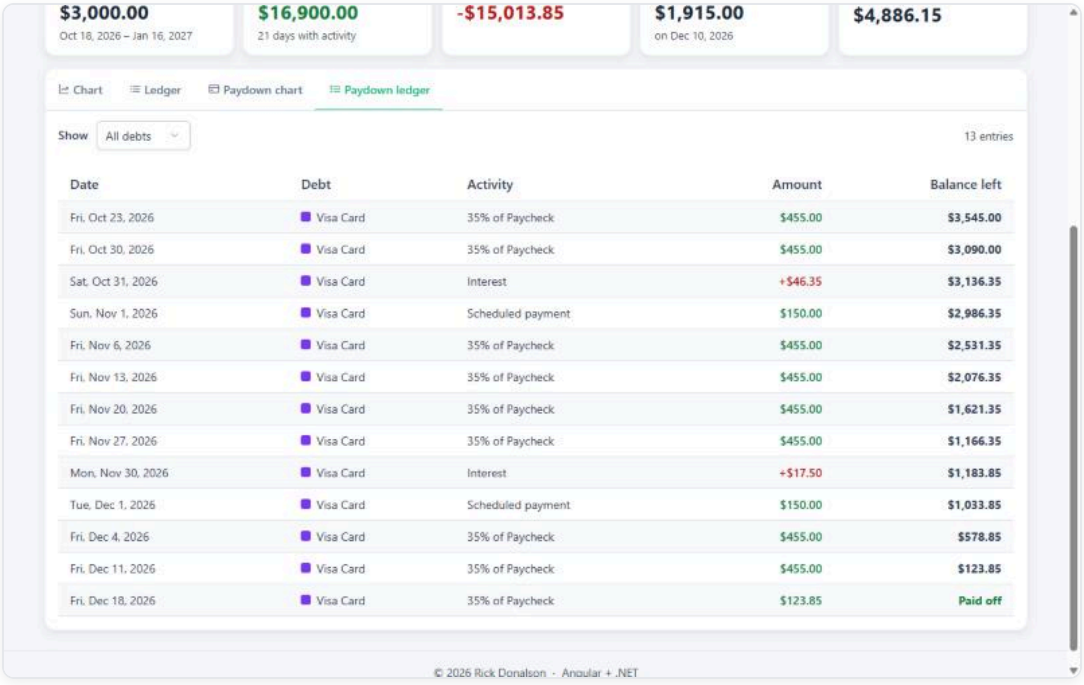
A credit can't be split more than 100% across all your debts; the dialog tells you how much is left ("30% left"). The trash can on a card stops tracking that debt but keeps the debit.

On Display, two extra tabs appear once you track a debt. Money sent to debts also comes out of your main forecast, so the balance there stays accurate.

- **Paydown chart** — a card per debt (owed at the start and end of the range, paid, interest, payoff date) and each debt's balance falling toward $0.
- **Paydown ledger** — every scheduled payment, allocation and interest charge, with the balance left; **Show** filters to one debt.



The Paydown chart tab

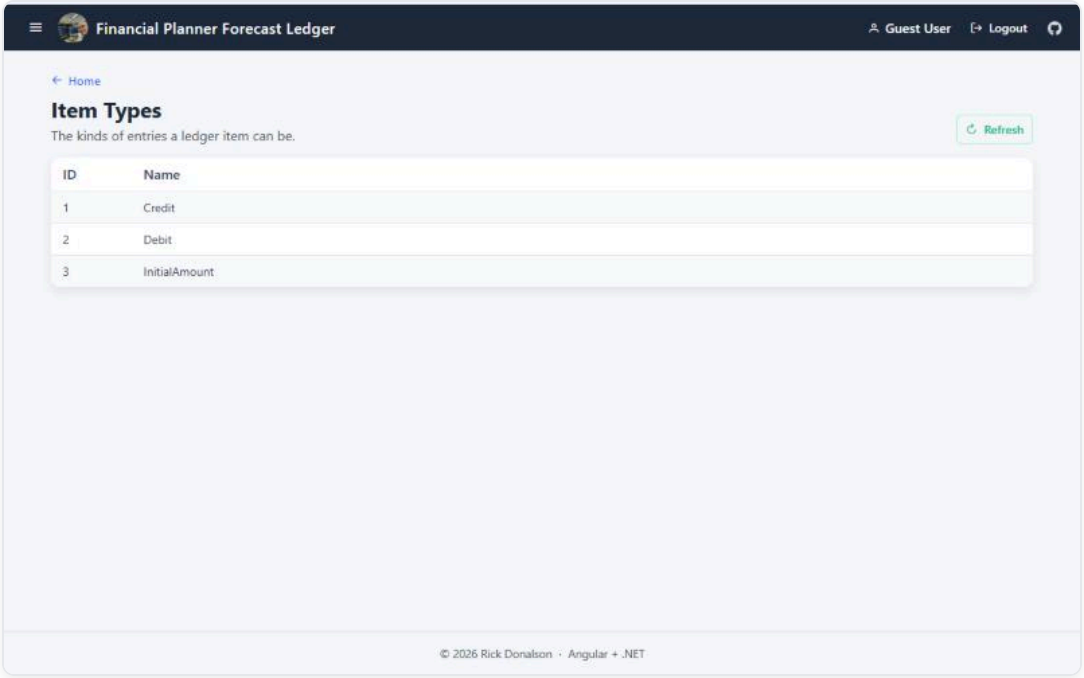


The Paydown ledger tab

If a debt won't be paid off within 30 years at the current rate, the card says so; raise the allocation or the payment.

Item types and time periods

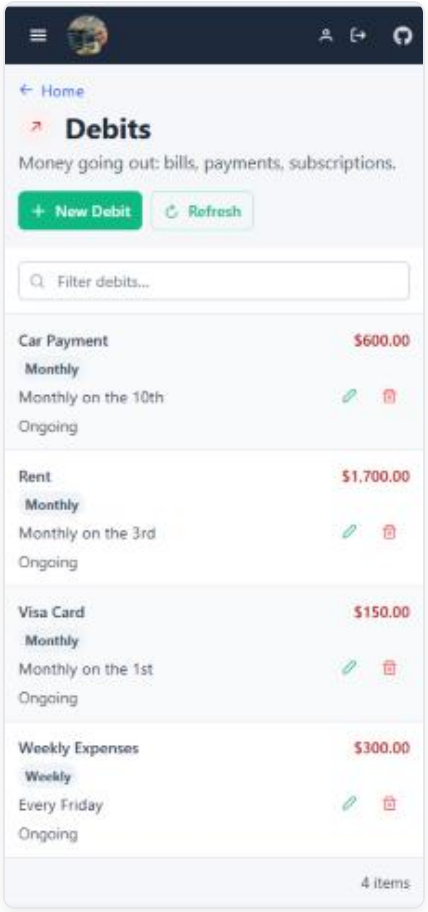
These reference lists define the kinds of items (Credit, Debit, Initial Amount) and the ten time periods. Everyone can view them from the home page; only admins see them in the menu and can add, rename or delete entries.



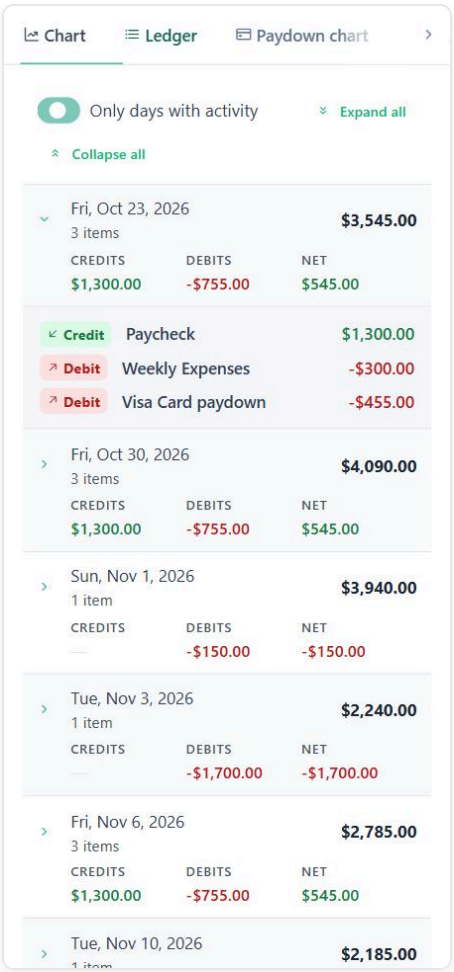
The Item Types list

On a phone

Every page fits a phone screen. Tables become stacked cards: an item's name and amount on top with its schedule below, and a ledger day as its date and balance with credits, debits and net underneath. The Display tabs scroll sideways when they don't all fit.



Debits on a phone



The ledger on a phone, one day expanded